

SHIRIL SAJU

Email: shirilsaju@gmail.com Website: www.shirilsaju.in

POMS EEDSA Awardee | Herbalife Sustainability Fellowship Awardee | Ex-Bajaj Auto Ltd.

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Management Bangalore, India 2021–2026
Ph.D. in Production and Operations Management, CGPA: 3.61/4
Thesis: Government Interventions for Socially Beneficial Technology Adoption
Committee: Nishant Kumar Verma (Chair), Ananth Krishnamurthy, Rajeev R. Tripathi

National Institute of Technology Calicut, India 2012–2016
B.Tech in Mechanical Engineering, CGPA: 9.36/10

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Technology Adoption in Operations Ecosystems, Strategic Service Operations, Operations under Uncertainty and Learning, Sustainable and Societal Operations

PAPERS UNDER REVISION / REVIEW

Farmer Cooperative-Led Precision Agriculture Adoption in Emerging Economies

Co-author: Nishant Kumar Verma (IIMB)
Status: **Under revision for resubmission to *Production and Operations Management* (UTD 24; FT50)** [First Decision: Reject & Resubmit]
Conferences: INFORMS MSOM 2025 (UK), EurOMA 2025 (Italy), POMS 2024 (USA), EurOMA Sustainable Operations Forum 2024 (Germany)

Evaluating the Ecosystem Facilitating Agriculture Technology in Emerging Economies

Co-author: Nishant Kumar Verma (IIMB)
Status: **Under 2nd round review at *International Journal of Production Economics* (ABS 3; ABDC A)**[First Decision: Revise & Resubmit]

WORKING PAPER

Intertemporal Pricing and Learning Strategies in Precision Agriculture under Dual Uncertainty [Job Market Paper]

Co-authors: Nishant Kumar Verma (IIMB), Nagesh Murthy (University of Oregon)
Status: Manuscript in advanced preparation. Planned Submission: January 2026.
Conference: EurOMA Sustainable Operations Forum 2025

WORK IN PROGRESS

Technology Intervention to Improve Precision Agriculture Awareness among Farmers: A Field Experiment

Co-authors: Nishant Kumar Verma (IIMB), Ashish Kumar Jha (Trinity Business School)
Status: In Progress. IRB Approved. Planned Completion of Data Collection: June 2026.
Partner: Kerala Agricultural University
Funding: IIMB Research Seed Grant
Conference: Behavioral Operations Conference 2025 (Germany)

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, IIMB (2021–2023)

With Prof. Jishnu Hazra on *Impact of Covid Second-Wave on Indian Automotive Industry*

With Prof. Nishant Kumar Verma on *Urban Air Mobility Infrastructure and Coalition Formation*

PRACTICE-ORIENTED PUBLICATIONS

Shiril Saju, Nishant Kumar Verma (2025). *Why start-ups should care about operations early on*, Hindustan Times.

Shiril Saju, Nishant Kumar Verma, Sandith Thandasherry (2024). *Solar boats: Opportunities and challenges towards achieving sustainable water transport*, Manufacturing Today.

Shiril Saju, Nishant Kumar Verma (2022). *5 hurdles India needs to overcome to become a global drone hub by 2030*, Forbes India.

TEACHING CASE STUDIES WITH TEACHING NOTE

Navalt: Scaling Solar-Electric Boatbuilding through Supply Chain Choices

Co-author: Nishant Kumar Verma (IIMB)

Position in Course: Operations Management, Entrepreneurial Operations, Strategy, Entrepreneurship

Status: **Under revision for resubmission to *Harvard Business Publishing***
[First Decision: Revise and Resubmit]. Planned Resubmission: January 2026.

Accelerating Project Management: Seamless Integration Through SPEED

Co-authors: Nishant Kumar Verma (IIMB), Kamalika Chakraborty

Position in Course: Project Management

Status: Manuscript in advanced preparation.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Operations Management, Entrepreneurial Operations, Strategic Decision-Making in Competitive Environments, Supply Chain Risk & Resilience, Revenue Analytics & Dynamic Pricing

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor, IIMB (2023–2026)

Probability and Statistics (PreDoc Course):	7.5 hrs (5 sessions)	Rating: 4.89/5 (12 Students)
Quantitative Techniques (PGP Prep):	9 hrs (6 sessions)	Rating: 4.77/5 (46 students)
Probability and Statistics (PhD Prep):	1.5 hrs (1 session)	Rating: 4.61/5 (42 students)
Service Ops (Foundations of Mgmt. Prog.):	1.25 hrs (1 session)	Rating: 4.4/5 (64 students)
Operations Management (DEI Initiative):	10.5 hrs (7 sessions)	Rating: 4.13/5 (10 students)

Tutorial Sessions as Teaching Assistant, IIMB (2023–2026)

Operations Mgmt. (PGPEM Core):	3 hrs (2 sessions)	Rating: 4.92/5 (76 students)	Grade: Excellent
Operations Mgmt. (EPGP Core):	4.5 hrs (3 sessions)	Rating: 4.90/5 (82 students)	Grade: Excellent
Project Mgmt. (PGP Elect.):	No Tutorials		Grade: Excellent
Operations Mgmt. (PGP Core):	4.5 hrs (3 sessions)		Grade: Excellent
Operations Mgmt. (PGP Core):	4.5 hrs (3 sessions)		Grade: Excellent

Other TA Responsibilities: Exam design and grading, case evaluation, class participation grading.

TEACHING TESTIMONIALS

“His ability to connect all concepts with real life situations keeps us engaged throughout.”

“Very engaging and detailed course.”

“The pace, content everything is good.”

“Good session with hands on practice also was good.”

“Amazing faculty.”

DOCTORAL COURSEWORK

Operations Management (PGP Core); Advanced Supply Chain Management; Game Theory; Stochastic Models; Inventory Control; Econometrics I & II; Empirical Research in Operations Management; Probability & Statistics; Linear, Nonlinear, and Dynamic Programming; Statistical Inference; Microeconomics; Behavioural Economics; Marketing Models; Revenue Management.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Bajaj Auto Ltd. (2016–2021) — Assistant Manager, Robotics and Machines (Operations BU)
Supplier evaluation and development, production quality improvement, readiness for technology adoption, robotics and automation design.

Hindustan Machine Tools Ltd. (2014) — Intern
Exposure to job shop processes for low-volume production.

Kerala Minerals & Metals Ltd. (2013) — Intern
Exposure to continuous processes for high-volume production.

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS

Herbalife Sustainability Fellowship (2025-2026)
EurOMA Inclusiveness Program Grant (2025)
EurOMA Summer School, University of Nottingham (2025)
POMS Nagesh Murthy Emerging Economies Doctoral Student Award (Honorable Mention) (2024)
IIMB Doctoral Fellowship (2021–2026)
VidyaSamunnathi Scholarship, Govt. of Kerala (2013–2016)

WORKSHOPS / CERTIFICATIONS

Doctoral Consortium on Teaching, IIMB (2025)
Winter Research Methodology Workshop, IIMB (2024)
Advanced Methods for Transportation and Logistics Research, IIMA (2024)
Human Subjects Research Certification, CITI (2024)
Qualitative Research Methods, IIMB (2024)
Data Visualization and Storytelling, DCAL IIMB (2023)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Track Chair, International Sustainability Conference, IIMB (2025)
Reviewer, AOM Annual Meeting (OSCM Division, 2025)
Reviewer, IIMB Management Review (2024–)
Track Chair, Supply Chain Management Conference, IIMB (2024)
Business Plan Judge, Aspiring Women Entrepreneurs Program (GoK&IIMB, 2023)
Senior Volunteer, IMRDC Conference, IIMB (2023)

OTHER POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

PhD SAC Alumni, Placement, Media Representative, IIMB (2023–2024)
PhD SAC Administrative Representative, IIMB (2021–2022)
Head, SAE Collegiate Club, NITC (2014–2015)
Head, Mechanical Engineering Association, NITC (2014–2015)
Event Manager, Annual Tech Fest (Tathva), NITC (2014)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

POMS, EurOMA, DSI

SOFTWARE SKILLS

Research Tools: R, Mathematica
Other: L^AT_EX, MS Office, Zotero, Canva

REFERENCES

Nishant Kumar Verma

Associate Professor
Production and Operations Management
Indian Institute of Management Bangalore
nishant.verma@iimb.ac.in

Nagesh Murthy

Roger Engemann Professor of Operations and
Business Analytics
University of Oregon, USA
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Ananth Krishnamurthy

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Decision Sciences
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Ashish Kumar Jha

Professor
Business Analytics
Trinity Business School, Ireland
akjha@tcd.ie